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The preview of Xfce in Linux Mint.

that it works smoothly all the time. However, it is still less popular than GNOME or KDE.

Basics of XFCE

Now that we've discussed desktop environments at length in the previous chapter, our next stop is the Xfce desktop environment. If you're familiar with the concept of installation of Xfce, the other sections covered in this chapter will be easier to understand.

In this chapter, we'll talk about the in-depth analysis of the Xfce desktop environment and its benefits, features, merits, as well as demerits. We've also listed the steps or pointers to help you install the desktop environment without hassles. Let's get started with our main topic without wasting any more time.

From which desktop environment is it derived?

XFCE stands for "XForms Common Environment". The project that gave birth to XFCE started in 1996 as the Common Desktop Environment. It was launched as the Linux version. However, initially, it was under proprietorship, then it was released as a free version. Later, it went its separate way from the Common Desktop Environment or CDC and became independent as Xfce.

Since then, Xfce has changed a few times. The codes of Xfce were rewritten, and it didn't have the XForms toolkit in its algorithm. This